DESIGN THINKING & PRODUCT LIFECYCLE MANAGEMENT

ASSIGNMENT 09: PRODUCT ANALYTICS IN DTPLM

A Scientific Framework for Telemetry-Driven Decision Making & Closed-Loop PLM Evolution

Subject: Design Thinking & Product Lifecycle Management (DTPLM)	**Assignment No.:** 09	**Academic Term:** Semester 7 / 2026
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Core Architectural Principle: *'Design Thinking tells us what to build. Product Analytics tells us whether what we built is actually working.' Product Analytics is not a static post-launch audit; it is an active feedback bridge synchronizing human-centered empathy with empirical lifecycle evolution.*

1. Foundations of Product Analytics & the DTPLM Connection

Product Analytics is the systematic capture, modeling, and interpretation of behavioral telemetry and qualitative sentiment generated while users interact with a product. In traditional engineering, development frequently terminated at deployment. In modern **Product Lifecycle Management (PLM)** combined with **Design Thinking (DT)**, deployment marks the beginning of iterative truth-discovery.

The DTPLM Closed-Loop Continuum: Product Analytics connects each phase into an unbroken feedback cycle:

Customer Need (Empathize/Define) → **Design & Spec (Ideate/Tokens)** → **Prototype / MVP (Next.js & DB)** → **Product Launch (Live Deploy)** → **Analytics & AI (Telemetry/NLP)** → **Next Version (Closed Loop)**

Practical Telemetry Example: In an on-demand medical app (such as MedNotes or Swiggy), telemetry captures critical drop-off funnels: *User Login → Patient Search → Pre-visit Summary Review → Consultation Note Entry → Diagnosis Submission → Prescription Dispatch*. Tracking where physicians pause or abandon reveals real clinical friction.

2. Key Performance Indicator (KPI) Architecture

A **Key Performance Indicator (KPI)** is a quantifiable measure designed to evaluate the success of an organization or product in reaching a specific target objective. A cardinal mistake in product management is confusing superficial *vanity metrics* with *actionable KPIs*.

- **Vanity Metric:** Numbers that look impressive on paper but provide no causal insight into customer success (e.g., total registered accounts, raw app downloads).
- **Actionable KPI:** Metrics that directly reflect value delivery, operational efficiency, or retention (e.g., 30-day active retention rate, time-to-first-diagnosis).

Product Strategic Goal	Superficial Metric	Actionable KPI (DTPLM)	Strategic Rationale
Accelerate clinical workflow adoption	Total doctor accounts created	**Daily Active Doctors (DAD) & WAU**	Measures sustained habitual clinical utility rather than one-time curiosity.
Minimize physician administrative burnout	Number of notes clicked	**Avg. Time spent per SOAP entry**	Quantifies direct time saved by Gemini-assisted documentation.
Improve diagnostic documentation quality	Total words typed per note	**Structured SOAP Completeness %**	Validates adherence to clinical protocol and insurance compliance.
Elevate doctor-patient satisfaction	App store star rating count	**Net Promoter Score (NPS) / CSAT**	Captures qualitative sentiment and willingness to advocate.
Strengthen platform stickiness	Total page views logged	**30-Day Cohort Retention Rate**	Isolates whether product changes create lasting recurring value.

3. KPI Selection Across the 5 Stages of Design Thinking

Design Thinking operates as a human-centered discovery engine. Product Analytics grounds each phase in quantifiable reality:

1. Empathize: Uncovering Latent Pain Points
Physicians express frustration: *'I spend 40% of patient consultation time typing repetitive EHR records.'*
Target Analytics: Baseline documentation time, frequency of truncated records, unassisted error rates.

2. Define: Formulating Precise Problem Statements
Statement: *'Clinicians need a rapid, structured SOAP workspace with AI summaries to reduce note-taking to under 3 minutes per patient.'*
Success Metric: Benchmark reduction in clinical session duration from 8.5 mins to < 3.0 mins.

3. Ideate: Hypothesis & Architectural Solutioning
Proposed Innovation: Dual-pane split-screen interface displaying patient history via pgvector semantic search while doctor enters SOAP diagnosis.
Anticipated Metrics: Summary read rate, suggestion acceptance rate, cognitive load reduction.

4. Prototype: Formative Validation & Usability Testing
Build working MVP with Next.js, Gemini API, and Supabase RLS permissions.
Formative KPIs: Time-to-first-note, UI interaction misclicks, field completion drop-off rate, task error rate.

5. Test: Summative Validation in Clinical Production
Deploy prototype to clinical user cohorts and measure real behavioral telemetry.
Summative KPIs: Weekly active doctors, AI summary edit distance, consultation turnaround time, CSAT score.

4. Customer Feedback Analysis & Mixed-Methods Synthesis

Quantitative telemetry explains **WHAT** users do, while qualitative feedback reveals **WHY** they do it. Sustainable product development mandates synthesizing both:

- **Quantitative Data:** Logged telemetry such as drop-off percentages, latency metrics, session lengths, and click heatmaps.
- **Qualitative Data:** Subjective user opinions from physician interviews, feedback widgets, support tickets, and open-ended surveys.

Feedback Classification Framework: Problem → Evidence → Product Improvement

Customer Voice / Feedback	Underlying Problem	Empirical Evidence	Actionable Product Improvement
'Finding previous lab reports during consultation takes too long.'	Poor clinical search UX & fragmented records	65% of consultation time spent navigating file trees	**Implement pgvector semantic search** bar with auto-retrieval of relevant vitals.
'I get bombarded with notifications for minor vitals updates.'	Alert fatigue & lack of priority thresholds	42% of doctors disabled app notifications entirely	**Introduce alert triaging:** Push notifications restricted to Red-Flag abnormal values.
'The note editor feels cramped when reviewing timeline.'	Modal dialog blocks contextual timeline review	70% modal close-and-reopen cycle per consultation	**Redesign as Split-Pane Workspace:** Timeline on left, SOAP inputs on right.
'AI summary generated terms I had to rewrite completely.'	Hallucination or excessive verbosity in prompt	AI summary text edited by > 75% of physicians	**Tune Gemini prompt with structured JSON schema** and clinical few-shot examples.

5. A/B Testing: Empirical Evidence in Design Thinking

A/B testing is the controlled scientific comparison of two variants (Variant A = Control, Variant B = Treatment) exposed concurrently to statistically equivalent user samples. It transforms subjective design debates into objective, data-backed decisions.

A/B Experiment Formulation (MedNotes Clinical Note Workflow):
- **Problem Statement:** Doctors spend 6.8 minutes per patient filling multi-page modal dialog forms.
- **Null Hypothesis (H■):** Introducing a unified split-pane SOAP workspace will produce no difference in note completion time or quality.
- **Alternative Hypothesis (H■):** The split-pane workspace with live AI summaries reduces documentation time by ≥ 30% without reducing SOAP fidelity.

Metric / Parameter	Variant A (Modal Form)	Variant B (Split-Pane SOAP)	Variance / Statistical Lift
Sample Cohort (Doctors)	250 Clinicians	250 Clinicians	Balanced Random Split (50/50)
Total Clinical Encounters	2,400 Encounters	2,450 Encounters	High Statistical Power
Avg. Note Completion Time	6.8 minutes	3.4 minutes	**-50.0% Reduction ($p < 0.001$)**
Full SOAP Completion Rate	62.5% (1,500 / 2,400)	91.8% (2,249 / 2,450)	**+46.9% Uplift ($p < 0.001$)**
Physician Satisfaction (CSAT)	3.2 / 5.0	4.7 / 5.0	**+46.8% Satisfaction Gain**

Decision Rule: Because Variant B demonstrated statistically significant uplifts in completion rate (+46.9%) and halved documentation duration, the product team confidently depreciated the modal dialog and permanently adopted the Split-Pane SOAP Workspace in production.

6. Product Analytics Across the 10 Product Lifecycle (PLM) Stages

Product analytics is not an isolated event. It integrates into every phase of the PLM continuum to maintain customer alignment:

PLM Lifecycle Stage	Analytics & Telemetry Activity	Primary Artifact / Deliverable
1. Idea Generation	Market survey analytics, sentiment on existing EHRs, doctor pain point frequency	Opportunity sizing matrix
2. Requirements	Feature ranking analysis, clinical workflow gap telemetry, compliance constraints	Product Requirement Doc (PRD)
3. Design	Click-testing wireframes, tree-testing navigation hierarchies, UI contrast checks	Validated Figma design system
4. Prototype	Lab usability sessions, time-to-first-click, cognitive confusion points	Formative test scorecard
5. Minimum Viable Product (MVP)	First cohort onboarding completion, basic event tracking, critical crash telemetry	MVP baseline dashboard
6. Commercial Launch	Daily active signups, login conversion funnels, Supabase API latency monitoring	Launch health monitor
7. Growth	Viral referral coefficients, hospital department adoption velocity, organic WAU	Growth cohort curves

8. Maturity	Feature depth utilization, DAU/MAU stickiness ratio, enterprise support tickets	Retention & churn matrix
9. Improvement	Rigorous A/B split testing, UX micro-copy optimization, bug frequency heatmaps	Continuous optimization log
10. Next Version (Evolution)	Telemetry-driven backlog prioritization, retirement of low-usage features	V2.0 Architectural roadmap

7. The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Modern Product Analytics

Modern analytics extends beyond passive data aggregation through Large Language Models (LLMs) and Machine Learning (ML):

• **Automated Feedback Categorization:** NLP pipelines ingest unstructured physician feedback, classifying comments into categories: Bug, Usability Defect, Performance Issue, Feature Request, or Positive Commendation.

• **Multi-Aspect Sentiment Analysis:** AI isolates sentiment per subsystem. Example: *'The AI SOAP notes are brilliant (+0.92), but search indexing latency is frustrating (-0.78).'* Product teams immediately pinpoint where friction resides.

• **Predictive Churn & Drop-off Modeling:** Supervised ML algorithms detect subtle engagement declines (e.g. physician login interval widening from 1 day to 4 days) and alert customer success before account churn occurs.

• **Prescriptive AI Recommendations:** LLM reasoning engines analyze usage telemetry and autonomously generate actionable architectural proposals: *'Cache recent patient vitals locally; 38% of doctors experience 1.8s latency retrieving historic labs.'*

8. Practical Activity: 'Improve an Existing Product' (Worksheet)

In accordance with the DTPLM curriculum activity, this section applies the end-to-end framework to our focus project (**MedNotes**) alongside a consumer platform benchmark (**Spotify**):

PRODUCT CASE STUDY 1: MedNotes (MediKiosk+ Clinical Consultation Workspace)
Step 1 — Strategic Product Goal: Enable outpatient physicians to conduct faster, error-free clinical documentation and formulate structured SOAP notes without excessive administrative screen time.
Step 2 — Three Core Actionable KPIs: 1. *Avg. Documentation Time per Encounter:* Target < 3.0 minutes (down from baseline 7.5 mins). 2. *AI Summary Acceptance Rate:* Percentage of Gemini-generated pre-visit summaries retained without substantial re-typing (Target > 80%). 3. *30-Day Active Physician Retention:* Proportion of clinicians maintaining weekly active usage after onboarding (Target > 85%).
Step 3 — Three Critical Customer Feedback Complaints (Categorized): • *Complaint 1 (Usability):* 'Switching between past history tabs and the SOAP editor causes me to lose my train of thought.' • *Complaint 2 (Performance):* 'Generating the AI pre-visit summary occasionally spins for over 5 seconds on mobile Wi-Fi.' • *Complaint 3 (Data Integrity):* 'Accidentally hitting backspace in browser navigation discarded an unsaved draft note.'
Step 4 — Controlled A/B Test Design: • **Control (Variant A):** Standard manual modal form with multi-tab history navigation. • **Treatment (Variant B):** Split-pane dual-window layout featuring live Gemini 3.6 RAG history summary on the left and auto-saving structured SOAP inputs on the right. • **Experiment Duration & Cohort:** 30 days across 40 hospital outpatient clinics (N = 500 clinicians).
Step 5 — Empirical Decision & PLM Iteration: Variant B yielded a 48% reduction in note-taking time ($p < 0.001$) and zero reports of discarded drafts due to auto-save debouncing. **Decision:** Deprecate modal dialog; roll out Split-Pane SOAP workspace as standard in Release v1.4.

PRODUCT CASE STUDY 2: Consumer Benchmark (Spotify Music Discovery)
Step 1 — Product Goal: Maximize user discovery of diverse music genres and increase daily session listening duration. **Step 2 — Three KPIs:** (1) Daily Discovery Time (mins), (2) Songs Saved from Recommendations (%), (3) 30-Day Subscriber Retention. **Step 3 — Customer Feedback:** 'Discover Weekly feels repetitive', 'Genre search filters are clunky', 'Recommended songs repeat artists I already follow.' **Step 4 — A/B Test:** Algorithm A (Collaborative Filtering based on recent history) vs Algorithm B (Contextual Multi-Armed Bandit with Serendipity Weighting). **Step 5 — Product Decision:** Algorithm B demonstrated +18% higher track save rates and +12% longer listening sessions. Adopt Algorithm B across all active accounts.

9. Synthesis, Conclusion & Formal Declaration

Synthesis Summary: Product Analytics bridges the gap between creative intuition and engineering validation. By integrating continuous telemetry, actionable KPIs, mixed-method qualitative feedback, and rigorous A/B experimentation across the 10 stages of the product lifecycle, product teams ensure that every architectural update solves genuine user problems.

Student Declaration: I hereby declare that this assignment represents original analytical work synthesized from lecture tutorials, Design Thinking methodologies, and hands-on system architecture implemented in our MedNotes project.	**Academic Evaluation:** Status: **Completed** Grade / Remarks: _____ Faculty Signature: _____